

ASK A DOCTOR

What will happen when I go for a gestational diabetes screening? You'll be given a very sugary drink and asked to wait for an hour, after which your blood will be tested. If your levels are high, you'll have to take a glucose tolerance test, which is similar, but longer. If you do have gestational diabetes, you will be taught how to test your blood sugar at home. You'll likely be able to control your condition with diet and exercise.

It's reassuring to know that most women who have sugar in their urine have normal blood-sugar levels in the glucose test.

PLANNING AHEAD

There will not be as much time for household chores once the baby is born. If you don't like living in a mess, act now to prevent resentment (and the laundry) from building up in a few months' time.

- Talk to your partner now about how you're going to split the chores once you have a newborn.
- Your "job" will be to nurture your baby, so you'll need domestic backup, if possible, particularly during the first few weeks. Recruit helpers (family and friends; or pay professionals if needed). Delegate so that you won't have to think about shopping, cooking, or cleaning.
- New parents need their own space, so it's never too early to arrange for some babysitters for a few weeks after the birth. If you're breastfeeding, you'll need to express your milk.